

Ex. 7. If the sum of two numbers is 10 and the sum of their reciprocals is $\frac{5}{12}$, find the numbers. (P.C.S., 2006)

Sol. Let the numbers be x and y .

$$\text{Then, } x + y = 10 \quad \dots(i)$$

$$\text{And, } \frac{1}{x} + \frac{1}{y} = \frac{5}{12} \Rightarrow \frac{x+y}{xy} = \frac{5}{12} \Rightarrow xy = \frac{10 \times 12}{5} = 24 \quad \dots(ii)$$

$$\therefore x - y = \sqrt{(x+y)^2 - 4xy} = \sqrt{(10)^2 - 4 \times 24} = \sqrt{100 - 96} = \sqrt{4} = 2 \Rightarrow x - y = 2 \quad \dots(iii)$$

Adding (i) and (iii), we get: $2x = 12$ or $x = 6$.

Putting $x = 6$ in (i), we get: $y = 4$.

Hence, the required numbers are 6 and 4.

Ex. 8. Three numbers are in the ratio 3 : 2 : 5. The sum of their squares is 1862. Find the numbers. (R.R.B., 2007)

Sol. Let the numbers be $3x$, $2x$ and $5x$.

$$\text{Then, } (3x)^2 + (2x)^2 + (5x)^2 = 1862 \Rightarrow 9x^2 + 4x^2 + 25x^2 = 1862$$

$$\Rightarrow 38x^2 = 1862 \Rightarrow x^2 = \frac{1862}{38} = 49 \Rightarrow x = \sqrt{49} = 7.$$

Hence, the numbers are 21, 14 and 35.

Ex. 9. The sum of seven consecutive natural numbers is 1617. How many of these numbers are prime? (S.S.C., 2006)

Sol. Let the seven consecutive numbers be x , $(x + 1)$, $(x + 2)$, $(x + 3)$, $(x + 4)$, $(x + 5)$ and $(x + 6)$.

$$\text{Then, } x + (x + 1) + (x + 2) + (x + 3) + (x + 4) + (x + 5) + (x + 6) = 1617$$

$$\Rightarrow 7x + 21 = 1617 \Rightarrow 7x = 1596 \Rightarrow x = 228.$$

Thus, the numbers are 228, 229, 230, 231, 232, 233 and 234.

Of these numbers, only two numbers i.e. 229 and 233, are prime.

Ex. 10. The product of two consecutive numbers is 4032. Find the numbers. (Bank P.O., 2008)

Sol. Let the numbers be x and $(x + 1)$.

$$\text{Then, } x(x + 1) = 4032 \Rightarrow x^2 + x - 4032 = 0 \Rightarrow x^2 + 64x - 63x - 4032 = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow x(x + 64) - 63(x + 64) = 0 \Rightarrow (x + 64)(x - 63) = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow x = 63. \quad [\because x \neq -64]$$

Hence, the required numbers are 63 and 64.

Ex. 11. The sum of two numbers is 15 and the sum of their squares is 113. Find the numbers. (R.R.B., 2006)

Sol. Let the numbers be x and $(15 - x)$.

$$\text{Then, } x^2 + (15 - x)^2 = 113 \Rightarrow x^2 + 225 + x^2 - 30x = 113$$

$$\Rightarrow 2x^2 - 30x + 112 = 0 \Rightarrow x^2 - 15x + 56 = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow (x - 7)(x - 8) = 0 \Rightarrow x = 7 \text{ or } x = 8.$$

So, the numbers are 7 and 8.

Ex. 12. The average of four consecutive even numbers is 27. Find the largest of these numbers.

Sol. Let the four consecutive even numbers be x , $x + 2$, $x + 4$ and $x + 6$.

$$\text{Then, sum of these numbers} = (27 \times 4) = 108.$$

$$\text{So, } x + (x + 2) + (x + 4) + (x + 6) = 108 \text{ or } 4x = 96 \text{ or } x = 24.$$

$$\therefore \text{Largest number} = (x + 6) = 30.$$

Ex. 13. The sum of the squares of three consecutive odd numbers is 2531. Find the numbers. (R.R.B., 2010)

Sol. Let the numbers be x , $x + 2$ and $x + 4$.

$$\text{Then, } x^2 + (x + 2)^2 + (x + 4)^2 = 2531 \Rightarrow 3x^2 + 12x - 2511 = 0 \Rightarrow x^2 + 4x - 837 = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow (x - 27)(x + 31) = 0 \Rightarrow x = 27.$$

Hence, the required numbers are 27, 29 and 31.